cursory reading of the evidence makes it abundantly clear that the wounds had not healed. Sparks flew in the exchanges.

In presenting his evidence, Krishna Aiyangar did not mince words. Describing the prevailing condition of the shipping industry in India as 'highly deplorable', he squarely blamed it on 'the unfair competition' with 'absolutely no protection from the alien government', underlining the alien nature of the government more than once.[32] Even though, tactically, Krishna Aiyangar disavowed politics his entire evidence is suffused with a patriotic spirit. For instance, when the committee questioned him about the economic unviability of some ports, he retorted: 'I would rather view it from a national spirit; we should not be guided by consideration of rupees, annas, and pies only.'[33] Describing the free trade policy of the Indian government as 'interested', he deployed the argument for protection of infant industries, calling for the reserving of coastal trade to Indian vessels apart from providing government 'bounties' (subsidies). 'The shipping trade between Indian and other countries should entirely lie in the hands of vessels owned by the people of this country and registered in India.'[34] Acutely aware of how the government's lucrative mail contracts gave BI an upper hand, he suggested that they be given to Indian companies plying regularly between two ports: here he perspicaciously added that 'perfect regularity' rather than being a precondition would be 'a consequence of the grant of the contract'.[35]

At this point, an Indian member, Samaldas drew attention to 'the very strong language in a certain place' in Krishna Aiyangar's statement and asked if he could 'substantiate his remarks'. The passage to which he took exception ran as follows: 'An industry which, primitive even as it existed, has been ruthlessly killed by the encouragement given by an unsympathetic alien Government to shipping companies in which the alien nation, and sometimes the highest officers of the Indian Government, had a vested interest.' Bold words indeed! Left with little option, Krishna Aiyangar conceded that 'the language is rather unhappy' and agreed to retract the passage.[36]